## MAKKAH ZIYARAT: 8

# GRAVE OF SAYYEDA KHADIJA (R.A.)

### Location

Jannat al Mualla cemetery, Al Hajun district, approximately one kilometer north of Masjid al Haram in Makkah, Saudi Arabia.

### Timings

Open year round with regulated access; men may enter at specific times often linked to funerals, while women are generally not permitted inside but may stand outside the wall to make du'a.

### About This Site

The grave of Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.) lies within Jannat al Mualla, also known historically as Al Hajun, the oldest and most revered cemetery in Makkah. This is the final resting place of the first believer in Islam, the beloved wife of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, and the Mother of the Believers who stood by him through the hardest years of revelation. Her presence here makes this cemetery one of the most emotionally significant sites for pilgrims seeking to connect with the earliest chapter of Islamic history.

Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.) was not only the Prophet's ﷺ wife but also his greatest supporter, confidante, and source of strength during the initial years of prophethood. She believed in him when others doubted, supported him financially when he was persecuted, and comforted him when the weight of revelation became overwhelming. Her death in the tenth year of prophethood, known as the "Year of Sorrow," marked one of the most painful losses in the life of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ.

GRAVE OF SAYYEDA KHADIJA (R.A.)

Muslims remember this site not for any elaborate monument or structure, but for the profound love, sacrifice, and faith that Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.) represented. Her grave, though unmarked like all others in the cemetery, holds a special place in the hearts of those who understand her role in the birth of Islam. For pilgrims performing Hajj or Umrah, visiting Jannat al Mualla offers a moment of deep reflection on the cost of faith and the legacy of those who carried Islam through its darkest hours.

## Historical Significance

### The First Believer and Mother of the Believers

Sayyeda Khadija bint Khuwaylid (r.a.) was the first person to accept Islam, making her the first believer in the history of the faith. When Prophet Muhammad ﷺ received the first revelation in the cave of Hira, it was Khadija (r.a.) who immediately believed his message and became his first supporter. Her acceptance of Islam set the foundation for the entire Ummah that would follow.

- She was the first to declare the Shahadah and believe in Prophet Muhammad ﷺ.
- She is honored with the title "Mother of the Believers" in the Qur'an.
- The Prophet ﷺ never married another woman during her lifetime.

### Unwavering Support During the Early Years of Islam

The early years of prophethood were marked by intense persecution, isolation, and hardship for Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.) stood firmly by his side, providing emotional, spiritual, and financial support when the message of Islam was rejected by the Quraysh. Her wealth was spent in the cause of Allah, and her home became a sanctuary for the early Muslims.

- She used her wealth to support the Prophet ﷺ and the early Muslim community.

GRAVE OF SAYYEDA KHADIJA (R.A.)

- She comforted him during the most difficult moments of revelation and persecution.
- Her support allowed the Prophet ﷺ to continue his mission despite opposition.

**The Year of Sorrow and Her Passing**

The tenth year of prophethood is known in Islamic history as the "Year of Sorrow" because it marked the deaths of both Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.) and Abu Talib, the Prophet's ﷺ uncle and protector. Khadija's (r.a.) death was an immense personal loss for Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, who deeply grieved her passing. She was buried in Jannat al Mualla, the cemetery of the Quraysh in Makkah.

- She passed away in the tenth year of prophethood, approximately three years before the Hijrah.
- Her death occurred during a time of intense hardship for the early Muslim community.
- The Prophet ﷺ never forgot her kindness and continued to honor her memory throughout his life.

**The Prophet's ﷺ Lasting Love and Remembrance**

Even after her death, Prophet Muhammad ﷺ continued to speak of Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.) with deep love and respect. He would remember her kindness, her faith, and her sacrifices, and he honored her friends and family throughout his life. This enduring remembrance shows the depth of their bond and the unique place she held in his heart.

- The Prophet ﷺ frequently mentioned her virtues and expressed gratitude for her support.
- He maintained close ties with her relatives and friends even after her death.
- He described her as one of the greatest women of Paradise.

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## The Site Today

### Physical Appearance Today

Jannat al Mualla is a large, walled cemetery with simple, unmarked graves in accordance with Islamic burial tradition. The site is well maintained but deliberately modest, with no elaborate structures or monuments over individual graves.

### Historical Remains and Structures

No original markers or structures remain over the grave of Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.). Like all graves in the cemetery, hers is unmarked, and the exact location is traditionally identified rather than archaeologically confirmed.

### Modern Development and Surroundings

The area around Jannat al Mualla has developed significantly with Makkah's expansion. The cemetery is now surrounded by modern buildings and infrastructure, yet it remains a distinct and protected historical site.

### Access for Visitors

Access to Jannat al Mualla is regulated by Saudi authorities. Men may be permitted entry at specific times, often linked to funeral processions, while women are generally not allowed inside but may stand outside the boundary wall to make du'a.

### Why Pilgrims Still Visit

Pilgrims visit Jannat al Mualla to honor the memory of Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.) and to reflect on her unparalleled role in the history of Islam. This cemetery is a tangible connection to the earliest days of the faith, where many of the Prophet's ﷺ family members and companions were laid to rest.

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For many visitors, standing at the boundary of Jannat al Mualla evokes deep emotions of gratitude, humility, and love for those who sacrificed everything for Islam. It is a reminder that faith often requires immense personal cost, and that the legacy of the early Muslims continues to inspire generations of believers.

- To honor the memory of Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.) and her unmatched support for Islam.
- To reflect on the sacrifices of the early Muslims buried in this sacred cemetery.
- To connect with the history of the Prophet's ﷺ family and companions.
- To renew one's own commitment to faith through remembrance of those who came before.

**Frequently Asked Questions**

**Where is the grave of Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.) located?**

Her grave is in Jannat al Mualla cemetery, also known as Al Hajun, approximately one kilometer north of Masjid al Haram in the Al Hajun district of Makkah, Saudi Arabia.

**Can visitors enter Jannat al Mualla to see the grave?**

Access is regulated by authorities; men may enter at specific times often linked to funerals, while women are generally not permitted inside but may stand outside the wall to make du'a.

**Why is Jannat al Mualla significant for pilgrims?**

It is the burial place of Sayyeda Khadija (r.a.), the first believer in Islam, along with many other family members of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ and early Muslims, making it a site of deep historical and spiritual importance

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